



AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Air traffic controllers are responsible for managing aircraft traffic, ensuring that flights are completed safely and that airport runways and parking stands are used efficiently. In this role, you must be calm under pressure while tracking aircraft in flight and directing them at takeoff, landing, and also on the ground.



SALARY

Trainee controller ★★★★★

Senior controller ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Highly competitive industry • Aviation sector growing as global air traffic increases • Concerns for job security due to privatization of airlines and airport authorities

CAREER PATHS

Most controllers train with their country's aviation authority to gain the license required to work. Training takes several years to complete and involves specializing in one area of air traffic control. Progression comes in the form of increased seniority and responsibility; changing to a different specialty is rare, due to the high cost of retraining.

GRADUATE You must have a bachelor's degree or three years of work experience to apply. A rigorous application process tests your skills, aptitude, and general health. You must also pass a background check to get security clearance.

ASSISTANT In some regions, you can apply directly to airport operators to work as an air traffic control assistant, training on the job to qualify as a controller.



AREA CONTROLLER

Tracks and monitors aircraft as they fly across one of a number of defined areas of air space. The job is usually based at a large regional control center.



AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER As an air traffic controller, you will be trained to specialize in one of three distinct roles: area controller, approach and departure controller, or tower/aerodrome controller. With experience, you can take on management responsibility.